

village works in the Mēda and Tambagamu and Kandawel pattus of the kōralé for the present year, and arranged that work should commence next month. The roads to be up are :—

- (1) Mādampé towards Hunuwela through Nāritsa and Mākandura.
- (2) Mādampé towards Ranwela through Emitiyagōda and Konapitiya.
- (3) Ambawila to Nalugasara and Galpāya.
- (4) Galpāya to Welléwa.

Meeting for Pannil pattu not yet held.

In the afternoon went out to inspect repair of bridges and work done on road from Mādampé to Balawinna. Extremely dissatisfied with the work done on bridge one mile from the resthouse. Bridge planks split and uneven, and not nailed down, and approaches to bridge not repaired at all. Work done by defaulters under overseer Jayasuriya satisfactory.

June 15.—A.M. to Rakwāna. The road from Pēlmadulla to Rakwāna is good. There is very little traffic on it. Inspected bazaar, parts of which I found dirty. Reprimanded sergeant and ordered him to prosecute owners of premises in Police Court next week. Examined books at police station and visited old resthouse, which is unoccupied. The Raṭémahatmayā of Atakalan kōralé should be ordered to keep a man in charge. Went up to Magistrate's residence, which is in good order, but it is pitiable to see the garden overgrown with weeds and no fence round it. I applied for an estimate for this last year, but it was not allowed. If a permanent fence cannot be given I would strongly advise a small grant of Rs. 30 a year to the Police Magistrate to maintain this fence, without which the grounds cannot be kept clean. There are no prisoners at Rakwāna to make the fence. Then went on to court-house to see what repairs have been done to it,—to sign completion report. It is utter waste of money spending a cent on this miserable building, which is not fit for a cattle shed; and I do trust that the estimate for the new court-house to be built on the site in the bazaar selected will be included in this year's Supply Bill. It is astonishing how the Rakwāna bazaar has increased and improved during the last year—a proof of the success of tea plantations in the district.

I also visited a thriving Buddhist school in the bazaar started by an ex-convict. Excellent building, good teacher, and good attendance. The new Church Missionary Society church is also well advanced, and begins to show, but the site for it, in centre of bazaar, is as bad as could have been chosen.

Breakfasted at resthouse, and in the afternoon walked up to Everton gap and on to Mr. Borrett's residence on Martinstown, in the North Kukulū district, nine miles. Road in great want of repair, and rain pouring in torrents.

June 16.—Walked through Springvale with Mr. Borrett and met Mr. Perera, Superintendent of Hon. Justice Dias' estates, Deepdene and Melbroke, in this District, who showed me new bridge put up by him over the oya on this estate: good for foot traffic, but I should hesitate about taking a horse over it; it is a serviceable bridge. Went over road back to Rakwāna with Mr. Perera and overseers, and showed where and what work to be done. Mr. Perera will repair the two bridges at Menikwatta and over Rambuke-oya. I also went over his new trace and sanctioned the road being diverted along it. Three miles from Rakwāna there is a very serious landslip, and the road has fallen in two places at least 20 ft. The whole side of the hill is certainly coming away, and the present path is very dangerous. Mr. Perera has made a good trace avoiding this slip, which is also shorter, and should be adopted. Forty-eight Ordinance labourers at work on this road this week.

I noticed some gem-pits sunk on Everton estate, quite close to the side of the road, sheer down about 40 ft. This is extremely dangerous, and I have taken action under The Wells and Pits' Ordinance to have them fenced. I also have written to ascertain if there was any reservation kept along this road at the time of its construction and survey; if so, it has certainly been encroached upon.

Drove down to Mādampé for breakfast and in to Ratnapura by coach from Pēlmadulla. Very heavy rain again. Thirty-eight miles.

June 17.—In Ratnapura.

June 18.—To Balangōda, thirty miles.

June 19.—With District Engineer to Bōwatta to inspect line of proposed extension of road from Bōwatta to Mulgama and towards Kaltōṭa. It was carried from the minor road to Bōwatta last year as a relief work—four miles—as far as the Bōwatta fields. District Engineer proposes to take road straight through the fields, but I strongly object to this line, and think every effort should be made to spare the fields. It is true that to take the road round will involve great expense, but even then I think the fields should be saved, for the road will only be a minor road and would not go on beyond Kaltōṭa.

As regards the road to Mulgama, which is necessary for transport of materials for repair of tank in that village which has been sanctioned, the ūrachchi states he can find a good trace, and this he will get cleared under village committee rules. Visited new school at Bōwatta: attendance good, but might be better. Twenty-four Ordinance labourers at work on road from Balangōda to Mēdagan-oya. Showed the overseer what work should be done in repair of hills, &c.

At resthouse Overseer Ponambalam (Public Works Department) charges Letchiman Chetty with theft of his property and a large quantity of Government stores and tools kept in his house. Remanded the Chetty to custody of police and sent Raṭémahatmayā and sergeant to search Chetty's house and other houses suspected at Alutnuwara; but as the theft was committed on June 2, and the overseer has not reported the matter till the 19th, I doubt any of the articles being found. P.M., to Belihul-oya with District Engineer. Parts of road very bad.

June 20.—A.M., walked from Imbulpé through Denagama estate to Detanagala estate, fourteen miles, to inspect work done by Ordinance and hired labourers on this road, and to decide what remains to be done. Mr. Pett, Superintendent of Denagama estate, met me on the road. He has taken much pains to supervise the labour, and will spend the balance of the vote (Rs. 130) in blasting away rock at a most dangerous corner, and in making one of the fords safer, and in minor repairs. Road from end of this bridle-path to Maratenna and Mr. Layard's estate decidedly bad, and it must be repaired at once.

June 21.—Left Detanagala and walked down to Boltumbé, inspecting clearings and encroachments on the way. I then entered the dēwāla with the Raṭémahatmayā, and in presence of the temple officers verified the articles kept there. I found there the bow and four large arrows in good order; one smaller arrow broken and one very small gold one; also a very handsome dish. The bows and arrows are only of copper gilt.

It is amazing that these articles have not been stolen, and only their sacred character and the superstition attached to them preserves them. The temple doors are without locks. The box in which they are

Some of the headmen bring to my notice that when they take an accused to the Negombo police station on a Sunday or holiday they have to leave a man on guard and to pay a sum of 12½ cents for each meal given to the prisoner. Several headmen corroborate this. It seems very hard on the headmen that at a police station provided with a secure lock-up an extra watch should be demanded and the headmen called upon to feed the prisoner. I shall wait to hear what the headmen in the other pattus say, and then write about this.

I tell the headmen that they must take in an accused as soon as possible to court, whether it be a Sunday or holiday. There can be no doubt that hitherto that headmen have detained prisoners over a Sunday or a holiday to avoid the expense of feeding and guarding prisoners when the court is closed, but now that the law is so strict on this point, they will be seen to bring in all prisoners at once; but I hope that they will be relieved of the expense and necessity of guarding prisoners after delivery into police custody.

April 27.—Travelled to Mádampella. Road in good order. At 1 p.m. I hold a meeting of headmen to explain the new rules regarding the arrest of accused persons. Some of the headmen here corroborate what others told me at Minuwaggođa about the difficulty at the police station on a Sunday or holiday; and I inform them that I shall address Government on the subject.

June 22.— * * * * * The Government Agent forwards copy of a letter from the Police Magistrate, Avisáwella, in reply to mine, about the inconvenience complained of by the headmen in taking accused persons all the way from Mirigama to Avisáwella. The Police Magistrate suggests that in petty cases the offenders should be handed over in the presence of the Mudaliyár or Muhandiram to their parents or relations or friends, to be produced before the court at Pasyála; that in more serious cases the police at Pasyála be authorised to take charge of accused persons and escort them to Avisáwella; that in cattle-stealing cases the accused be taken to Avisáwella when the Police Magistrate is not sitting at Pasyála. I inform the Mudaliyár to direct his headmen to carry out these suggestions.

July 12.—Travel to Kotugoda and inspect native amuna across the Attanagala-oya and the site of the proposed masonry anicut. Without an amuna the landowners are unable to cultivate the range of fields alongside the oya. The native amunas are always being washed away, and the one built by the Public Works Department met the same fate. In compliance with the Government Agent's request in letter No. 442, I hold a meeting of proprietors of lands likely to be benefited by the proposed work, and explain to them the terms proposed, and after some discussion the majority agree to pay a water-rate of Re. 1 per acre of land till the cost of the work is paid for, on the understanding that the owners on the Colombo side of the oya do the same or pay their share in some way, as the work will benefit the landowners on both sides of the oya.

July 13.— * * * * * Walk on to Asgiriwelpola and there inspect the site of a proposed anicut across the Attanagala-oya. A survey and estimate have been made by the Public Works Department, and now I have to hold a meeting of proprietors as I did in Kotugoda. Proper notice has been given, and I hold the meeting in a large house by the roadside. A large number of proprietors appear, and after discussion, and my explaining to them the proposal made, they decline to pay a water-rate of Re. 1 per acre, but agree to pay one-third of the cost of the proposed work in ten years. From what I can gather only a few of the more influential and well-to-do people are anxious to have this work done, but the majority are quite indifferent, being satisfied with the existing native amuna.

August 11.—Local Board meeting. * * * * * The Board considers the question of a water supply for the town and of a scheme submitted by the District Engineer, Mr. Bingham. If there be a sufficient supply of good, wholesome water close to the sea-shore, the scheme seems to be a feasible one, namely, to pump the water into reservoirs by means of wind power. Mr. Bingham sends in six samples of water, and the Board resolves to forward them for analysis. If of course the water be found to be unfit for drinking there is an end of the scheme. Mr. MacBride proposes a water supply by gravitation from some river outside the town. I am afraid that in the dry weather the supply would fail; however, it is worth further investigation.

Resolved further, that the Government be informed that the Board is of opinion that Rs. 5,000 can be raised annually by a 5-per-cent. tax on all property within the limits to go towards a water supply in the event of an Ordinance being passed empowering the Board to levy the tax.

September 22.— * * * * * On the recommendation of the Government Agent the Board vote a sum of Rs. 372-50 for a survey in connection with Mr. MacBride's scheme for supplying Negombo with water.

The Board has not yet been informed of the exact nature of the scheme, but I believe it to be the damming of the Kimbulapitiya-oya, and so forming a large reservoir—the water to be conveyed to another reservoir in the town by means of a channel. As the analyst reports the water near the seashore in the town to be unfit for drinking purposes, the Board, for the present at any rate, lay aside the further consideration of Mr. Bingham's proposal to pump up water by means of wind mills into reservoirs. The water would of course have to be well filtered to make it wholesome.

The analyst condemns five samples of water sent to him, and reports that the only water fit for drinking is that from Periyamulla, from where the town is now supplied. If Mr. MacBride's scheme is found not feasible, I should think the best plan would be to procure a condensing machine, and so supply the town with good water.

The Government might, in the first instance, advance the money, and the Local Board undertakes to repay yearly so much of the principal and interest.

September 27.— * * * * * Receive letter from Government Agent enclosing copy of extract from Inspector-General of Police to Negombo Inspector, informing him that all prisoners in lawful custody of the Police should be guarded and fed. The fact of this not having been done previously is attributed to a mistaken provincial order of a former Superintendent. I am glad that now a definition has been given, and that the headmen who bring in accused on a Saturday, Sunday, or holiday will not have to guard and feed them in the police station.